

TUESDAY

FOCUS ON: Martha and Mary

READ TOGETHER: Luke 10:38-42

ANCHORED BY PRESENCE

And she had a sister called Mary, who also sat at Jesus' feet and heard His word. (Luke 10:39)

FOR FAMILY WORSHIP: Pages 24-26

FURTHER STUDY FOR PARENTS: Pages 27-29

DEVOTIONAL

THE COURAGE TO BE PRESENT

Do you hear the busy house? Feet move quickly across the floor, dishes make noise, and people talk near the door. Someone needs water, someone needs bread, and someone needs help. Martha is working hard because she loves Jesus and wants everything to be ready.

But in that same busy house, Mary makes a different choice. She sits close to Jesus and listens. She is not running around. She is not trying to prove she is important. She is not trying to be noticed. The Bible says, “Mary...sat at Jesus’ feet and heard His word” (Luke 10:39, NKJV). That small sentence shows a very big choice.

Mary teaches us that sometimes courage looks quiet. Courage is not always loud, fast, or strong on the outside. Sometimes courage means stopping when everything around us is moving. Sometimes courage means listening to Jesus before we rush to do the next thing.

Our homes can feel busy too. In a **VUCA WORLD**, where life can change quickly, feel uncertain, become confusing, and be hard to understand, our attention can be pulled in many directions. There are screens, sounds, messages, schoolwork, chores, plans, worries, and questions we do not always know how to answer. Sometimes our bodies are in one place, but our minds are running everywhere.

Jesus invites us to slow down and come close to Him. He is not asking for a perfect house or a perfectly quiet day. **He knows life can be noisy, busy, and full of interruptions. He simply asks for our attention, because when we listen to Him first, our hearts can become calm and our eyes can see each other with more love.**

Before we talk about screens, schedules, and choices, let’s begin where Mary began: close to Jesus, ready to listen. The world may rush, buzz, and pull, but with Jesus, our family can stop, breathe, and hear His word.

FAMILY PRAYER

Place distractions aside, take one deep breath, and pray: **“Dear Lord, help us sit close, listen first, and give full attention today. In Jesus’ name, amen.”**

READ

ASK

This is what Mary and Martha's world felt like:

VOLATILE: Roman rule stirred hopes for the Messiah.

UNCERTAIN: People wondered who Jesus was.

COMPLEX: Hospitality set gender roles.

AMBIGUOUS: Serve Jesus or stay close?

Although with God's help, we can turn it into:

VENTURE: Sit with Jesus and listen closely.

UNVEIL: Discover the one thing needed.

COMPASS: Share attention, not just space

ASSURANCE: Put away phones, choose connection.

In a **VUCA WORLD**, Mary shows us that true courage can begin with one quiet choice: sit down, listen, and be fully present with Jesus.

1 Read
Luke 10:38-42
together

2 Underline
the expression
"**only one thing
is necessary**"

3 Ask yourself:

- What keeps me busy but disconnected?
- Am I near you, but watching a screen?

Mary and Martha teach us that Jesus values hearts that listen, not just hands that stay busy. As your parent, I promise to stop, look at you, and listen with love, **so that you know you always matter more than my phone, or the rush to do chores, and my to-do list.**

FAMILY ACTIVITY: The Phone Garage

Decorate a small box or tray as your family's Phone Garage. Before dinner or worship, everyone 'parks' their phone and says, "**I choose to be present.**" Ask: "How did Mary show Jesus He mattered?" Then look at one person, listen to their answer, and give them a heart-hug or high-five.



**FURTHER STUDY
FOR PARENTS:**

ANCHORED BY PRESENCE

Today's Principle:
Practice True Presence

Today's promise for your home is attentive and steady:
Your loving attention can tell your child, "You matter more than any notification."

Mary's choice becomes a daily invitation to slow down, give our full attention, and create gentle rhythms at home where screens step aside so children feel seen, hearts grow calmer, and love finds time to listen before the rush of life begins again.

V VENTURE BEYOND FEAR IN A VOLATILE WORLD

A hurried home can make love feel silent, even when everyone is in the same room. Parents can be busy doing good things: cooking, working, cleaning, answering messages, helping children, and caring for many needs. But the story of Mary and Martha gently reminds us that doing many things for Jesus is not the same as being present with Him.

Martha was not wrong for serving. The problem was that her heart became pulled in too many directions. Mary shows another kind of courage. She stopped. She sat down. She listened. In a noisy, demanding world, presence may seem small, but it can become deeply powerful.

For parents, this is an invitation to notice where attention is going. A child may not need a perfect parent, but they do need a parent who is present. When we stop long enough to listen, we speak a powerful message without words: "You matter more than my hurry."

ASK YOURSELF TODAY: AM I FULLY PRESENT, OR SIMPLY NEARBY WHILE MY ATTENTION IS ELSEWHERE?

U UNVEIL DEEPER TRUTH IN UNCERTAIN TIMES

Read Luke 10:38–42 and underline Jesus' words: "only one thing is necessary." Martha was not wrong for serving. Her work mattered. The meal, the welcome, and the hospitality were good gifts. But she was carrying so much that she almost missed the Person in front of her.

Presence does not mean sitting still while life falls apart. Presence means knowing when love needs your full attention. It is choosing a child's voice over a notification, a family moment over another task, and listening over rushing.

TODAY ASK GENTLY: AM I DOING MANY GOOD THINGS, BUT MISSING THE HEART BESIDE ME?

C COMPASS THAT REMAINS STEADY THROUGH COMPLEXITY

Educational principles from Ellen White remind us that children are reached best through warm, caring relationships. Ellen White wrote, ***"Only as we come in touch through sympathy can we understand them; and we need to understand in order most effectively to benefit"*** (Education, p. 212).

This is the heart of presence. Parents do not guide children best from far away, or while distracted, rushed, or half-listening. We guide them by coming close. We teach by being truly present.

Being present is more than being in the same room. A family can sit together while everyone is living in a different world through a screen. True presence means sharing attention. It means looking into each other's eyes, listening without interrupting, putting the phone down when someone is speaking, and noticing feelings, not just words.

Jesus modeled this kind of presence. He did not love people from a distance. He stopped. He looked. He listened. He came close. When parents do the same, they give their children a powerful message: "You are more important than any notification."

This is why connection comes before correction. When children feel distant, rules can sound like control: “You just want to stop me.” But when they feel loved, seen, and understood, the same rule can sound like care: “You are protecting me.” The rule is the same; the relationship changes how children receive it.

Technology is not the enemy; distraction is. Busy parents may not have long hours, and that is okay. Presence means that when the family is together, everyone chooses to be truly together.

A STRONG BOND TURNS RULES INTO A LANGUAGE OF LOVE.

A ASSURANCE THAT STANDS FIRM AMID AMBIGUITY

This activity begins with the adults. Try a simple rhythm called **PRESENCE PARTNERS**, where Mom and Dad, or the caring adults at home, choose the first moments when phones will step aside.

Pick two daily spaces: a family space, like dinner or worship time, and a parent space, like 10 quiet minutes after the children sleep. Place the phones in a visible spot, not as punishment, but as a sign that love is choosing attention.

Before you begin, say together: “I choose to be present.” This turns the moment from a rule into a shared promise.

ASK YOURSELF: WHAT MOMENT CAN I PROTECT TODAY SO MY FAMILY FEELS SEEN AND LOVED?



ANCHORED BY PRESENCE

Martha was nearby, but Mary was connected. In a noisy **VUCA WORLD**, love stops, listens, and builds bonds strong enough to hold a family together when life runs fast today.